

CHAPTER 4

From the Diary of Anne Frank

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

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From the Diary of Anne Frank · Before You Read (Activity)

1 **Do you keep a diary? Given below under 'A' are some terms we use to describe a written record of personal experience. Can you match them with their descriptions under 'B'? (i) Journal (ii) Diary (iii) Log (iv) Memoir(s)**

✔ ANSWER

Term	Description
(i) Journal	A full record of a journey, a period of time, or an event, written every day
(ii) Diary	A book with a separate space or page for each day, in which you write down your thoughts and feelings or what has happened on that day
(iii) Log	A written record of events with times and dates, usually official
(iv) Memoir(s)	A record of a person's own life and experiences (usually, a famous person)

2 (i) **Decide whether the entry is from a diary, a journal, a log or a memoir: "I woke up very late today and promptly got a scolding from Mum! I can't help it — how can I miss the FIFA World Cup matches?"**

✔ ANSWER

Diary – it records personal thoughts and feelings about what happened that day.

2 (ii) **"10:30 a.m. Went to the office of the Director; 01:00 p.m. Had lunch with Chairman; 05:45 p.m. Received Rahul at the airport; 09:30 p.m. Dinner at home"**

✔ ANSWER

Log – it is a record of events with exact times, like an official record.

2 (iii) **"The ride to Ooty was uneventful. We rested for a while every 50 km or so ... From Ooty we went on to Bangalore. What a contrast! The noise and pollution of this once-beautiful city really broke my heart."**

✔ ANSWER

Journal – it is a record of a journey, written as the trip goes on.

2 (iv) **"This is how Raj Kapoor found me — all wet and ragged outside R.K. Studios ... he cast me on the spot. The rest, as they say, is history!"**

✔ ANSWER

Memoir – a famous person is recalling events from his/her own life and career.

From the Diary of Anne Frank · Oral Comprehension Check (1)

1 **What makes writing in a diary a strange experience for Anne Frank?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne had never written anything before. She also felt that later on neither she nor anyone else would be interested in the **"musings of a thirteen-year-old schoolgirl"**. So writing a diary felt strange to her.

2 **Why does Anne want to keep a diary?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne felt the need to "get all kinds of things off my chest". She had no true friend to confide in, so she wanted the diary to be her friend, whom she named **'Kitty'**.

3 **Why did Anne think she could confide more in her diary than in people?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne believed that **'paper has more patience than people'**. With her friends she could talk only about ordinary everyday things and could not get close to them. The diary would listen patiently and keep her secrets.

From the Diary of Anne Frank · Oral Comprehension Check (2)

1 **Why does Anne provide a brief sketch of her life?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne thought that no one would understand her stories to Kitty if she plunged right in. So, although she disliked doing it, she gave a brief sketch of her life and family first.

2 **What tells you that Anne loved her grandmother?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne says, "No one knows how often I think of her and still love her." At her birthday celebration in 1942, **Grandma's candle was lit** along with the rest. This shows her deep love for her grandmother.

From the Diary of Anne Frank · Oral Comprehension Check (3)

1 **Why was Mr Keesing annoyed with Anne? What did he ask her to do?**

✔ ANSWER

Mr Keesing was annoyed because Anne **talked too much** in class. After several warnings, he gave her extra homework: an essay on **'A Chatterbox'**.

2 **How did Anne justify her being a chatterbox in her essay?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne argued that **talking is a student's trait**. She would try to keep it under control, but could never cure the habit, because her mother talked as much as she did, and not much can be done about **inherited traits**.

3 **Do you think Mr Keesing was a strict teacher?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Not really. He punished Anne only with essays, laughed at her arguments, took her poem in the right spirit and even read it to other classes. He was firm but kind and had a good sense of humour.

4 **What made Mr Keesing allow Anne to talk in class?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne's third essay was a funny **poem** (written with Sanne's help) about a mother duck, a father swan and three ducklings bitten to death for quacking too much. Mr Keesing took the joke the right way, read it to many classes, and after that allowed her to talk.

🤔 From the Diary of Anne Frank · Thinking about the Text

1 **Was Anne right when she said that the world would not be interested in the musings of a thirteen-year-old girl?**

✔ ANSWER

No, she was wrong. Her diary, **The Diary of a Young Girl**, was translated from Dutch into many languages and became one of the world's most widely read books. Films, plays and even an opera are based on it, because it gives an honest record of daily life under Nazi occupation.

2 **There are some examples of diary or journal entries in the 'Before You Read' section. Compare these with what Anne writes in her diary. What language was the diary originally written in? In what way is Anne's diary different?**

✔ ANSWER

The entries in 'Before You Read' are short, factual records of events, times or a journey.

Anne's diary was originally written in **Dutch**.

It is different because she writes it as **letters to an imaginary friend, 'Kitty'**. She shares her inner thoughts, feelings and opinions, not just facts, in a personal and lively way.

3 **Why does Anne need to give a brief sketch about her family? Does she treat 'Kitty' as an insider or an outsider?**

✔ ANSWER

Anne gives a sketch of her family so that Kitty can understand her later stories. This shows that she treats Kitty as an **outsider** at first, someone who must be told the background, though she wants Kitty to become her closest friend.

4 **How does Anne feel about her father, her grandmother, Mrs Kuperus and Mr Keesing? What do these tell you about her?**

✔ ANSWER

- **Father:** "the most adorable father I've ever seen" – she loves him deeply.
- **Grandmother:** she still thinks of her often and loves her; Grandma's candle was lit on her birthday.

- **Mrs Kuperus:** her headmistress; both cried at their "heartbreaking farewell" – Anne was attached to her.
- **Mr Keesing:** she calls him an "old fogey" but gets along with him and turns his punishment into a joke.

This shows that Anne was **loving, emotional and sensitive**, yet also witty, frank and confident.

5 **What does Anne write in her first essay?**

✔ ANSWER

In her first essay, 'A Chatterbox', Anne argued that **talking is a student's trait**. She promised to keep it under control, but said she could never cure the habit because her mother talked as much as she did, and **inherited traits** cannot be changed much.

6 **Anne says teachers are most unpredictable. Is Mr Keesing unpredictable? How?**

✔ ANSWER

Yes. Anne expected punishment, but Mr Keesing had a good laugh at her first essay. Instead of being angry at the funny poem, he took the joke well, read it to several classes, allowed her to talk and began making jokes himself. His reactions could not be predicted.

7 (i) **What does this statement tell you about Anne Frank as a person? "We don't seem to be able to get any closer, and that's the problem. Maybe it's my fault that we don't confide in each other."**

✔ ANSWER

Anne is **honest and self-critical**. She longs for a true friend and is ready to accept that the fault may be hers.

7 (ii) **"I don't want to jot down the facts in this diary the way most people would, but I want the diary to be my friend."**

✔ ANSWER

Anne is **imaginative and lonely**. She wants a close friend to share her feelings with, so she makes her diary that friend.

7 (iii) **"Margot went to Holland in December, and I followed in February, when I was plunked down on the table as a birthday present for Margot."**

✔ ANSWER

Anne has a **good sense of humour**. She writes about her own life in a light, playful way.

7 (iv) **"If you ask me, there are so many dummies that about a quarter of the class should be kept back, but teachers are the most unpredictable creatures on earth."**

✔ ANSWER

Anne is **frank, confident and outspoken**. She gives her opinion boldly and comments on people with humour.

7 (v) **"Anyone could ramble on and leave big spaces between the words, but the trick was to come up with convincing arguments to prove the necessity of talking."**

✔ ANSWER

Anne is **intelligent and creative**. She thinks carefully and wants to do a task well with original, convincing arguments.

🤔 From the Diary of Anne Frank · Thinking about Language

I **Match the compound words under 'A' with their meanings under 'B'. Use each in a sentence. 1. Heartbreaking 2. Homesick 3. Blockhead 4. Law-abiding 5. Overdo 6. Daydream 7. Breakdown 8. Output**

✔ ANSWER

Word	Meaning

1. Heartbreaking	producing great sadness
2. Homesick	missing home and family very much
3. Blockhead	an informal word which means a very stupid person
4. Law-abiding	obeying and respecting the law
5. Overdo	do something to an excessive degree
6. Daydream	think about pleasant things, forgetting about the present
7. Breakdown	an occasion when vehicles/machines stop working
8. Output	something produced by a person, machine or organisation

Sentences (sample):

1. The news of the flood was heartbreaking.
2. Rahul felt homesick during his first week at the hostel.
3. Don't be a blockhead; read the question carefully.
4. Law-abiding citizens pay their taxes on time.
5. Exercise is good, but don't overdo it.
6. Riya often daydreams in the maths class.
7. We were late because of a breakdown of our bus.
8. The factory's output has doubled this year.

II 1 Look up the following in a dictionary for their meanings: (i) plunge (right) in (ii) kept back

(iii) ramble on (iv) get along with

✔ ANSWER

(i) **plunge (right) in** – start doing or saying something directly, without preparation

(ii) **kept back** – not promoted to the next class; made to stay in the same class

(iii) **ramble on** – talk or write for a long time in a confused way, without focus

(iv) **get along with** – have a friendly relationship with someone

II 2 **Find the sentences in the lesson that have the phrasal verbs given below. Match them with their meanings. Are their meanings the same as that of their parts? (i) plunge in (ii) kept back (iii) move up (iv) ramble on (v) get along with (vi) calm down (vii) stay in (viii) make up for (ix) hand in**

✔ ANSWER

Phrasal verb	Sentence in the lesson	Meaning
(i) plunge in	...if I were to plunge right in, I'd better provide a brief sketch of my life...	go straight to the topic
(ii) kept back	...teachers decide who'll move up to the next form and who'll be kept back.	not promoted

(iii) move up	...who'll move up to the next form...	go to the next grade
(iv) ramble on	Anyone could ramble on and leave big spaces between the words...	speak or write without focus
(v) get along with	I get along pretty well with all my teachers.	have a good relationship with
(vi) calm down	Even G.'s pleading glances and my angry outbursts can't calm them down.	make (them) remain quiet
(vii) stay in	...wondering whether to stay in or go out.	stay indoors
(viii) make up for	This birthday celebration in 1942 was intended to make up for the other...	compensate
(ix) hand in	I handed it in, and Mr Keesing had nothing to complain about...	give an assignment (homework) to a person in authority (the teacher)

Are the meanings the same as their parts?
Mostly no. 'Stay in' and 'move up' are close to the meanings of their parts, but plunge in, kept back, ramble on, get along with, calm down, make up for and hand in have special (idiomatic) meanings.

III 1 (i) **What does the idiomatic expression mean? "Our entire class is quaking in its boots."**

✔ ANSWER

quaking in its boots – very frightened and nervous (here, about the result).

III 1 (ii) **"Until then, we keep telling each other not to lose heart."**

✔ ANSWER

not to lose heart – not to lose hope or courage.

III 1 (iii) **"Mr Keesing was annoyed with me for ages because I talked so much."**

✔ ANSWER

for ages – for a very long time.

III 1 (iv) **"Mr Keesing was trying to play a joke on me with this ridiculous subject, but I'd make sure the joke was on him."**

✔ ANSWER

play a joke on someone – make fun of someone; trick someone to amuse others.

the joke was on him – he would himself look foolish instead of the person he tried to trick.

III 2 **Use these idiomatic expressions in sentences of your own: (i) caught my eye (ii) he'd had enough (iii) laugh ourselves silly (iv) can't bring myself to**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(i) A beautiful red kite in the shop window **caught my eye**.

(ii) The coach kept warning the noisy boys, but after an hour **he'd had enough** and sent them home.

(iii) We **laughed ourselves silly** at the clown's tricks.

(iv) I **can't bring myself to** tell my best friend that I am moving to another city.

IV (a) **Where — under which word — would you look for the expression 'caught my eye' in a dictionary? Which other expressions with 'catch' are listed in your dictionary?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Look under the word **catch** ('caught' is its past tense).

Other expressions with catch (sample): **catch fire** (begin to burn), **catch somebody's attention** (make someone notice), **catch your breath** (rest to breathe normally), **catch somebody red-handed** (find someone in the act of doing wrong), **catch up with** (reach the same level as), **catch a cold** (become ill with a cold).

IV 1 **Find the meaning of 'break somebody's heart' and use it in a sentence.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: make someone very sad.

Sentence: It broke her heart to leave her village.

IV 2 **close/dear to heart**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: very important to someone, loved very much.

Sentence: Helping poor children is a cause very close to my heart.

IV 3 **from the (bottom of your) heart**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: sincerely; with true feeling.

Sentence: I thank you from the bottom of my heart for your help.

IV 4 **have a heart**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: be kind; show pity (said to ask someone to be less harsh).

Sentence: Have a heart and let the tired child rest for a while.

IV 5 **have a heart of stone**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: be cruel; show no pity or feeling.

Sentence: The landlord had a heart of stone and threw the family out in the rain.

IV 6 **your heart goes out to somebody**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Meaning: feel deep sympathy for someone.

Sentence: My heart goes out to the people who lost their homes in the earthquake.

V 1 **Make a list of the contracted forms in the text. Rewrite them as full forms of two words.**

✔ ANSWER

Contracted form	Full form
I've	I have
doesn't	does not
I'm	I am
won't	will not
don't	do not
it's	it is
that's	that is
they're	they are
I'd	I had / I would
didn't	did not
who'll	who will
you're	you are
can't	cannot
we'll	we will
there's	there is
he'd	he had
who's	who is
Keesing's	Keesing is
haven't	have not

V 2 **Find in the text the contracted forms that stand for two different full forms, and say what these are.**

✔ ANSWER

- **I'd** = I had ("I'd better provide...", "after I'd finished...", "I'd nearly exhausted...") **or** I would ("I'd worry about that later", "I'd make sure the joke was on him").
- **he'd** = he had ("he'd finally had enough") or he would.
- **it's / who's / Keesing's** = ... is or ... has (in the text: it is, who is, Keesing is).

⭐ From the Diary of Anne Frank · Speaking

1 Try to make this extract sound more like a real conversation by changing some of the verbs back into contracted forms. Then speak out the lines.

MOB: Now where is your husband, mistress?

MARY: In his bed. He is sick, and weary. You would not harm him!

HOB: We are going to smash his evil work to pieces. Where is the machine?

SECOND MAN: On the table yonder.

HOB: Then here is the end of it!

HOB: And now for your husband!

MARY: Neighbours, he is a sick man and almost a cripple. You would not hurt him!

HOB: He is planning to take away our daily bread... We will show him what we think of him and his ways!

MARY: You have broken his machine... You have done enough...

✔ ANSWER

MOB: Now where's your husband, mistress?

MARY: In his bed. He's sick, and weary. You wouldn't harm him!

HOB: We're going to smash his evil work to pieces. Where's the machine?

SECOND MAN: On the table yonder.

HOB: Then here's the end of it!

[HOB smashes the model. MARY screams.]

HOB: And now for your husband!

MARY: Neighbours, he's a sick man and almost a cripple. You wouldn't hurt him!

HOB: He's planning to take away our daily bread... We'll show him what we think of him and his ways!

MARY: You've broken his machine... You've done enough...

⭐ From the Diary of Anne Frank · Writing

1 **Can you keep a diary for a week recording the events that occur? Use the hints: write as if for someone else; present thoughts convincingly; use words that convey feelings and 'paint pictures'; be brief. (Diary language: subjectless sentences, fragments, contracted forms, everyday expressions.)**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model diary (first three days of the week):

Monday, 16 November 2026

Dear Diary,

Got up late again! Missed the school bus and had to run all the way. Maths test in the first period... not bad, I think. Riya shared her lunch with me since I'd forgotten mine. Felt grateful. Evening — finished my science notes. Tired but happy.

Tuesday, 17 November 2026

Rain, rain, rain! The whole sky grey like an old blanket. PT period cancelled — so boring. But our English teacher read us a funny story and the whole class laughed itself silly. Mum made hot pakoras in the evening. Perfect!

Wednesday, 18 November 2026

Big day. Our class won the quiz competition! I answered the last question on Anne Frank. Couldn't believe it. Hands shaking when we got the trophy. Called Nani to tell her — she's so proud. Can't sleep with excitement.

(Continue in the same way for Thursday to Sunday.)

⭐ From the Diary of Anne Frank · Listening

1 **Your teacher will read out an extract from The Diary of Samuel Pepys about the great fire of London. As you listen, complete this summary: This entry in the diary has been made on ___ by ___. The person who told Pepys about the fire was called ___. She called at ___ in the morning. Pepys went back to sleep because ___. Pepys rose again at ___ in the morning. By then about ___ houses had been burned down. The fire had spread to ___ by London Bridge. Pepys then walked to the ___ along with Sir J. Robinson's ___.**

✔ ANSWER

This entry in the diary has been made on **2nd September (1666), the Lord's Day** by **Samuel Pepys**. The person who told Pepys about the fire was called **Jane**. She called at **about three o'clock** in the morning. Pepys went back to sleep because **he thought the fire was far enough off**. Pepys rose again at **about seven** in the morning. By then about **300** houses had been burned down. The fire had spread to **all Fish Street** by London Bridge. Pepys then walked to the **Tower** along with Sir J. Robinson's **little son**.

🤔 Amanda! · Thinking about the Poem

1 **How old do you think Amanda is? How do you know this?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Amanda is probably about **12–14 years old**, a young teenager. We know this because she is told not to eat chocolate and to **'remember your acne'**, which is common at this age. She is also told to finish her homework and tidy her room.

2 **Who do you think is speaking to her?**

✔ ANSWER

Her **mother** (or a parent/elder) is speaking to her, giving her a string of instructions and scolding her.

3 **Why are Stanzas 2, 4 and 6 given in parenthesis?**

✔ ANSWER

They are given in brackets because they are **Amanda's inner thoughts and daydreams**. She does not say them aloud. They show the imaginary world she escapes into while being scolded.

4 **Who is the speaker in Stanzas 2, 4 and 6? Do you think this speaker is listening to the speaker in Stanzas 1, 3, 5, and 7?**

✔ ANSWER

Amanda is the speaker in Stanzas 2, 4 and 6. No, she is not listening to her mother. She is lost in her own dreams of being a mermaid, an orphan and Rapunzel, which is why the mother says, "Will you please look at me when I'm speaking to you?"

5 **What could Amanda do if she were a mermaid?**

✔ ANSWER

As a mermaid she would **drift blissfully** in a calm ("languid"), emerald-green sea, where she would be the only inhabitant. No one would be there to order her about.

6 **Is Amanda an orphan? Why does she say so?**

✔ ANSWER

No, Amanda is not an orphan; she lives with her parents. She imagines being an orphan because then she could roam the streets freely, making patterns in the soft dust with her bare feet. For her, **"the silence is golden, the freedom is sweet"** – no one to nag her.

7 **Do you know the story of Rapunzel? Why does she want to be Rapunzel?**

✔ ANSWER

Rapunzel is a fairy-tale girl with very long golden hair, locked in a tower by a witch. The witch (and later a prince) climbed up to her using her hair.

Amanda wants to be Rapunzel because life in a tower is **"tranquil and rare"**, free of cares. Unlike Rapunzel, she would **never let down her hair**, so no one could come up to disturb or scold her.

8 **What does the girl yearn for? What does this poem tell you about Amanda?**

✔ ANSWER

Amanda yearns for **freedom, peace and solitude** – a life without constant orders and nagging. The poem shows that she is a sensitive, imaginative child who feels hurt by being corrected all the time and escapes into a world of daydreams.

9 **Read the last stanza. Do you think Amanda is sulking and is moody?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Amanda may look sulky and moody, but she is really **hurt and fed up** with the endless instructions. Her silence is a way of escaping. The mother's line "Anyone would think that I nagged at you" is ironic, because she has been nagging her all the time. So the real cause of Amanda's mood is the constant nagging.

🎉 **Chapter 4 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**